UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2010

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

1. Why did Buddhism start declining in India in the early medieval times?

1. Buddha was by that time considered as one of the incarnations and Vishnu of thus became a part of Vaishnavism.

2. The invading tribes from Central Asia till the time of last Gupta king adopted Hinduism and persecuted Buddhists.

3. The Kings of Gupta dynasty were strongly opposed to Buddhism.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only

(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : Buddha was considered 9th incarnation of Vishnu. No tribe from Central Asia persecuted Buddhists. Gupta dynasty did not oppose Buddhism. However, they did not give them patronage.

2. Among the following, who was not a proponent of bhakti cult?

(a) Nagarjuna (b) Tukaram

(c) Tyagaraja (d) Vallabhacharya

Ans. (a) : Nagarjuna was an Indian Buddhist philosopher who propounded the doctrine of emptiness or Sunyavada. He is not related to the Bhakti movement. Tukaram was the greatest Marathi Bhakti poet. Vallabhacharya and Tyagaraja were also followers of the Bhakti movement. So the correct answer is Nagarjuna.

3. There are only two known examples of cave paintings of the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of Ajanta caves. Where is the other surviving example of Gupta paintings?

(a) Bagh caves (b) Ellora caves

(c) Lomas Rishi cave (d) Nasik caves

Ans. (a) : There are only two known examples of cave paintings of the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of Ajanta caves and the other is Bagh caves.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

4. What was the immediate reason for Ahmad Shah Abdali to invade India and fight the Third Battle of Panipat?

(a) He wanted to avenge the expulsion by Marathas of his viceroy timur Shah from Lahore.

(b) The frustrated governor of Jullundhar Adina Beg Khan invited him to invade Punjab

(c) He wanted to punish Mughal administration for non-payment of the revenues of the Chachar Mahal (Gujrah, Aurangabad, Sialkot and Pasrur)

(d) He wanted to annex all the fertile plants of Punjab up to the borders of Delhi to his kingdom.

Ans. (a) : He wanted to avenge the expulsion by Marathas of his viceroy Timur Shah from Lahore.

MODERN HISTORY

5. For the Karachi session of Indian National Congress in 1931 presided over by Sardar Patel, who drafted the Resolution on Fundamental Rights and Economic Programme?

(a) Mahatma Gandhi

(b) Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru

(c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

(d) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar

Ans. (b) : Karachi session of Indian National Congress, 1931, presided over by Sardar Patel, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru drafted the Resolution on Fundamental Rights and Economic Programme.

6. Who among the following were official Congress negotiators with Cripps Mission?

(a) Mahatma Gandhi and Sardar Patel

(b) Acharya J.B. Kripalani and C. Rajagopalachari

(c) Pandit Nehru and Maulana Azad

(d) Dr. Rajendra Prasad and Rafi Ahmed Kidwai

Ans. (c) : The Cripps Mission was an attempt in 1942 by the British government to secure India's cooperation in World War II. The Mission was headed by Sir Stafford Cripps. Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru and Maulana Azad were official congress negotiators with Cripps Mission.

7. Consider the following statements:

1. The common wealth has no charter, treaty or constitution.

2. All the territories/countries once under the British empire (jurisdiction/rule/mandate) automatically joined the Commonwealth as its members.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : The Charter of the Commonwealth was adopted on 19th December, 2012 and was officially signed by Queen Elizabeth II at Marlborough House, London, on the Commonwealth Day on 11th March, 2013. The Commonwealth of Nations is a voluntary association of 53 independent sovereign states, most of which were once part of the British Empire. The Commonwealth's membership includes both republics and monarchies. The head of the Commonwealth of Nations is Queen Elizabeth II, who reigns as monarch directly in 16 member states known as Commonwealth realms.

8. With reference to Pondicherry (Now Puducherry), consider the following statements:

1. The first European power to occupy Pondicherry were the Portuguese.

2. The second European power to occupy Pondicherry were the French.

3. The English never occupied Pondicherry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : The first European power to occupy Pondicherry were the Portuguese. The first Europeans to exert power in India were the Portuguese who sailed round Southern Africa in search of the trade goods of the East such as pepper, cloves, silk. When they reached the coast of India and the islands further east, weapons technology and lack of moral scruples gave them advantage over the local regimes they found. They began to occupy parts such as Goa in India and towns in Indonesia.

9. Consider the following statements:

1. The "Bombay Manifesto" signed in 1936 openly opposed the preaching of socialist ideals.

2. It evoked support from a large section community from all across India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : The 'Bombay Manifesto signed in 1936 by 21 Bombay businessmen, contained an open indictment of Nehru's preaching of socialist ideals which were deemed prejudicial to private property and to the peace and prosperity of the country.

Although, it did not evoked support from any other section of the business community, it strengthened the hands of the moderates within the Congress like Bhulabhai Desai and G.B. Pant who put pressure on Nehru to tone down his socialist utterances.

10. Who among the following Governor Generals created the Covenanted Civil Service of India which later came to be known as the Indian Civil Service?

(a) Warren Hastings

(b) Wellesley

(c) Cornwallis

(d) William Bentinck

Ans. (c) : Lord Cornwallis created the Covenanted Civil Service of India which later came to be known as the Indian Civil Service.

11. What was the immediate cause for the launch of the Swadeshi movement?

(a) The partition of Bengal done by Lord Curzon

(b) A sentence of 18 months rigorous imprisonment imposed on Lokmanya Tilak

(c) The arrest and deportation of Lala Lajpat Rai and Ajit Singh, and passing of the Punjab Colonization Bill

(d) Death sentence pronounced on the Chapekar brothers

Ans. (a) : The government's decision to partition Bengal was made public in December 1903.The official reason given was that Bengal with a population of 78 million was too big to be administered. The government announced partition in July 1905. To boycott this on 7th Aug 1905 formal proclamation of Swadeshi movement was made from the Calcutta townhall.

12. Consider the following statements:

1. Dr. Rajendra Prasad persuaded Mahatma Gandhi to come to Champaran to investigate the problem of peasants.

2. Acharya J.B Kriplani was one of Mahatama Gandhi's colleagues in this Champaran investigation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 and 2

Ans. (b) : Acharya J.B Kriplani was one of Mahatama Gandhi's colleagues in this Champaran investigation. The correct answer is Only (2). Rajkumar Shula persuaded Mahatma Gandhi to come to Champaran to investigate the problem of peasant.

13. By a regulation in 1793, the District Collector was deprived of his judicial powers and made the collecting agent only. What was the reason for such regulation?

(a) Lord Cornwallis felt that the District Collector's efficiency of revenue collection would enormously increase without the burden of other work

(b) Lord Cornwallis felt that judicial power should compulsorily be in the hands of Europeans while Indians can be given the job of revenue collection in the districts